

# Putting the Peak Week Pieces Together



| Starting Conditioning Level                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Strategies                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Notes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
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| <b>Low Muscle Glycogen During Prep:</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Low carb diet</li> <li>• High volume RT</li> <li>• High volume CT</li> </ul>                                                                               | <p>Possible strategies include:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Carbohydrate load: Allow enough time</li> <li>• Consider RT Taper</li> <li>• Remove or reduce CT during peak week</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                | <p>Carbohydrate loading may cause unwanted water retention, so a low-to-moderate carb dry-out the day before competing may be needed to remedy this.</p>                                                                                                      |
| <b>Tendency for Water Retention</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Daily water weight fluctuation: Best appearance at lowest bodyweight</li> <li>• Spilling over watery look after carbohydrate loading</li> </ul>                | <p>Consider mild dehydration to ensure the best look guided by bodyweight. Possible strategies include:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Moderate water restriction (not elimination) on the day preceding contest day only</li> <li>• Water and sodium (Na+) manipulation per the Model Strategy</li> <li>• Supplementation and stress reduction</li> </ul> | <p>Psychological disturbance or emotional stress may cause water retention via dopamine, cortisol, and aldosterone.</p>                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Likelihood of High Muscle Glycogen</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• High carb diet</li> <li>• Low volume RT leading into competition/photoshoot</li> <li>• Low volume CT</li> </ul>                                          | <p>Consider only minimal carbohydrate loading. The load may be gradual, for several days or weeks, or can be based on trial run results.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | <p>Minimal loading may also be a valid strategy in heavily muscled, well-conditioned individuals with naturally round muscle bellies.</p>                                                                                                                     |
| <b>Minimal Water Retention</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Clear muscular definition is apparent</li> <li>• Minimal bodyweight fluctuations throughout the day, not at the expense of intentional water restriction</li> </ul> | <p>Ensure good hydration throughout peak week and on the day of competitions/photoshoot show to avoid loss of muscle fullness.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <p>Athletes are typically very lean in this case.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Special Circumstances</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Female bikini athletes aim to reduce the on-stage appearance of muscularity</li> </ul>                                                                                | <p>Athletes with excess muscularity may consider these possible strategies:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Hyperhydrate and add dietary sodium to blur muscularity.</li> <li>• Deplete muscles to create a less round, more streamlined look.</li> </ul>                                                                                                   | <p>These strategies may be used to even out the disparity in upper versus lower body muscularity in females with accentuated gynoid fat distribution patterns who may need to reduce upper bodyfat excessively to obtain the desired lower body leanness.</p> |